EPİSODE 002

PodCat English

"Phone English - Stop Avoiding Calls!"

EPİSODE TOPİC

Making Phone Calls in English, Overcoming Phone Anxiety

Hosts: Tekir & Luna

Duration: ~11 minutes

LİSTEN. LAUGH. LEARN.

Episode 002: "Phone English - Stop Avoiding Calls!"

Episode Information

- **Hosts:** Tekir & Luna
- **Topic:** Making phone calls in English, overcoming phone anxiety
- **Challenge from Ep 001:** Best 5 "great first impression" stories
- **New Challenge:** Make ONE phone call in English this week

SEGMENT 1: INTRO & HOOK (0:00-1:15)

TEKİR

Hey everyone! Welcome back to PodCat English! I'm Tekir!

LUNA

And I'm Luna! We are SO happy you're here for Episode 002!

TEKİR

Okay, quick question: Who gets NERVOUS when they have to make a phone call in English? Come on, be honest!

LUNA

If you're raising your hand right now, you're not alone. Even WE get nervous sometimes!

TEKİR

Oh, absolutely! There's something about not seeing the other person's face that makes it ten times harder, right?

LUNA

Exactly! You can't see their expressions, you can't use body language, and sometimes the connection is bad...

TEKİR

And they talk SO FAST! It's like: "Hello-this-is-John-from-customer-service-how-can-I-help-you-today?" And you're like... wait, what?

LUNA

(laughing) Yes! So today, we're tackling phone English. By the end of this episode, you'll feel WAY more confident making calls.

TEKİR

We've got essential phrases, role-play scenarios, and our community shoutout with YOUR success stories!

LUNA

Let's dive in!

SEGMENT 2: WHY PHONE CALLS ARE SCARY (1:15-3:30)

TEKİR

Alright, Luna, let's be real. Why are phone calls in English so terrifying?

LUNA

Great question! I think the number one reason is: no visual cues. When you're face-to-face, you can see if someone understands you. On the phone? Nothing.

TEKİR

Exactly! And you can't use hand gestures! I'm someone who talks with my hands a LOT, so on the phone, I feel... stuck!

LUNA

Another reason: speed. People talk faster on the phone because they want to be efficient. They're not thinking about non-native speakers.

TEKİR

Oh, and background noise! Sometimes you're calling and there's construction, traffic, or a crying baby in the background. It makes everything harder to understand.

LUNA

Plus, there's the pressure of real-time response. In a text message, you can take your time. On a call? You need to answer RIGHT NOW.

TEKİR

And let's not forget technical vocabulary! If you're calling customer service or booking something, they use specific words you might not know.

LUNA

But here's the good news: all of these challenges have solutions! And we're about to give them to you.

TEKİR

The key is preparation. If you know what to expect and have some phrases ready, phone calls become SO much easier.

LUNA

Think of it like this: the more calls you make, the more comfortable you get. It's just practice!

TEKİR

Alright, let's get practical!

SEGMENT 3: ESSENTİAL PHONE PHRASES (3:30-5:30)

LUNA

Okay, here are the phrases you NEED to know for phone calls. Let's break them down!

TEKİR

First: Opening the call. How do you start?

LUNA

If YOU'RE calling someone:

- "Hello, this is [your name] calling about [reason]."
- "Hi, I'd like to speak to [person's name], please."
- "Good morning, I'm calling to ask about [topic]."

TEKİR

Simple and clear! Now, what if THEY call you?

LUNA

If you're answering:

- "Hello, this is [your name] speaking."
- "[Your name] here, how can I help you?"
- Or just: "Hello?"

TEKİR

Perfect! Now, this is super important: what if you don't understand something?

LUNA

DON'T pretend you understood! Use these:

- "I'm sorry, I didn't catch that. Could you repeat it, please?"
- "Could you speak a bit slower, please?"
- "I'm sorry, could you spell that for me?"

TEKİR

Yes! It's not rude to ask someone to repeat. It's actually more professional than guessing!

LUNA

Now, what if you need to put someone on hold?

- "Could you hold for just a moment, please?"
- "Just one second, please."

TEKİR

And if you need to leave a message?

- "Could I leave a message for [person]?"
- "Please let them know that [your name] called."
- "Could you ask them to call me back at [your number]?"

LUNA

Finally: closing the call.

- "Thank you for your help!"
- "I appreciate your time."
- "Have a great day!"

TEKİR

And then just: "Goodbye!" or "Bye, take care!"

LUNA

See? Not so scary when you have the phrases ready!

TEKİR

Pro tip: write these down BEFORE you make a call. Have them in front of you. It's like a cheat sheet, and there's nothing wrong with that!

SEGMENT 4: ROLE-PLAY SCENARİOS (5:30-7:30)

LUNA

Okay, Tekir, ready for some role-play?

TEKİR

Oh, I love this part! Let's do it!

LUNA

Scenario 1: You're calling a hotel to make a reservation. I'll be the hotel receptionist. You start!

TEKİR

Okay! *(clears throat)* Hello, I'd like to make a reservation for two nights, please.

LUNA

(receptionist voice) Of course! May I have your name, please?

TEKİR

Yes, it's Tekir. T-E-K-I-R.

LUNA

(receptionist voice) Thank you, Mr. Tekir. What dates were you looking at?

TEKİR

I'd like to check in on March 15th and check out on March 17th.

LUNA

(receptionist voice) Perfect! And how many guests?

TEKİR

Just two adults.

LUNA

(receptionist voice) Wonderful! I have a room available. May I have a contact number?

TEKİR

Sure! It's 555-0123.

LUNA

(receptionist voice) Great! Your reservation is confirmed. We'll see you on March 15th!

TEKİR

Thank you so much! Have a great day!

LUNA

(normal voice) See? That wasn't so bad!

TEKİR

Okay, now let's do a harder one. Luna, YOU call customer service because your internet isn't working.

LUNA

Oh no, the dreaded tech support call! Okay, here we go. *(clears throat)* Hello, I'm calling because my internet connection isn't working.

TEKİR

(tech support voice) I'm sorry to hear that! Let me help you. Can I have your account number, please?

LUNA

Um, I don't have it with me right now. Can I give you my phone number instead?

TEKİR

(tech support voice) Sure! What's your number?

LUNA

It's 555-7890.

TEKİR

(tech support voice) Got it! Okay, have you tried restarting your router?

LUNA

I'm sorry, could you repeat that? I didn't catch the last part.

TEKİR

(tech support voice, slower) Have you tried restarting your router? Just unplug it and plug it back in.

LUNA

Oh! Yes, I tried that, but it didn't work.

TEKİR

(tech support voice) No problem! I'll send a technician to your location. Is tomorrow morning okay?

LUNA

Yes, that works! Thank you so much for your help!

TEKİR

(tech support voice) You're welcome! Have a great day!

LUNA

(normal voice) And there you go! Even when things don't work, you can handle it!

TEKİR

The key is: don't panic, use your phrases, and ask for clarification when you need it!

SEGMENT 5: PHONE-IN Q&A (7:30-8:30)

TEKİR

Alright, time for our phone-in segment! We've got questions from YOU, our listeners!

LUNA

First question is from Emma in Germany. She asks: "What do I do if I can't understand someone's accent on the phone?"

TEKİR

Great question, Emma! First, don't be embarrassed. Accents can be tricky, especially on the phone.

LUNA

Just say: "I'm sorry, I'm having trouble understanding. Could you speak a bit slower, please?" Most people will be happy to help!

TEKİR

And if it's REALLY bad, you can say: "I'm sorry, the connection isn't great. Could we try again?" Sometimes that gives you both a fresh start.

LUNA

Next question: Carlos from Spain asks, "Is it okay to write down what I want to say before I call?"

TEKİR

Carlos, YES! Absolutely! That's actually what we recommend!

LUNA

Write down:

- Why you're calling
- Key information (dates, numbers, names)
- Questions you want to ask
- Important phrases

TEKİR

Think of it like having notes for a presentation. Professionals do this all the time!

LUNA

Last question: Maria from Italy asks, "How do I politely end a call when someone talks too much?"

TEKİR

(laughing) Oh, we've all been there!

LUNA

You can say: "I'm sorry, I have to go now. Thank you so much for your help!" Or: "I don't want to take up more of your time. Thanks again!"

TEKİR

Another trick: "I have another call coming in. Thanks so much, bye!"

LUNA

It's polite but firm. You're not being rude, you're just managing your time!

SEGMENT 6: COMMUNİTY SHOUTOUT (8:30-10:00)

TEKİR

Alright everyone, it's time for our Community Shoutout!

LUNA

Last week, we asked you: "Tell us about a time YOU made a GREAT first impression in English!" And WOW, you guys showed up!

TEKİR

We got so many amazing stories! Choosing just five was SO hard!

LUNA

But here are our Top 5 success stories from this week!

TEKİR

Number 5: @AnnaFromRussia123 said: "I was at a coffee shop in London, and I complimented the barista's tattoo. We ended up talking for 20 minutes, and she gave me her Instagram! I made a friend just by being brave!"

LUNA

Yes, Anna! That's what it's all about! Small compliments can lead to big connections!

TEKİR

Number 4: @RajFromIndia123 wrote: "I had a job interview in English. I was SO nervous, but I prepared well. I introduced myself confidently, made eye contact, and smiled. I got the job!"

LUNA

Raj! That's incredible! Preparation really does make all the difference!

TEKİR

Number 3: @LeilaFromBrazil123 shared: "I was lost in New York and asked a stranger for directions. Instead of just pointing, he walked me there! I think my polite English and smile made him want to help."

LUNA

Leila, that's so sweet! Being polite and friendly opens so many doors!

TEKİR

Number 2: @MikeFromPoland123 said: "I joined an online gaming team, and everyone spoke English. I introduced myself clearly and asked good questions. Now we play together every weekend!"

LUNA

Mike, that's awesome! Gaming is such a great way to practice English!

TEKİR

And our NUMBER ONE story comes from @YunaFromKorea123 who said: "I was at a conference and introduced myself to a speaker I admire. I told her I loved her work and asked a thoughtful question. She gave me her business card and later became my mentor!"

LUNA

Yuna! That is AMAZING! One confident introduction changed your life!

TEKİR

See, everyone? Great first impressions can lead to friendships, jobs, and even mentorships!

LUNA

Thank you to Anna, Raj, Leila, Mike, and Yuna! You're all inspiring us!

SEGMENT 7: NEXT WEEK'S CHALLENGE (10:00-10:45)

TEKİR

Okay everyone, before we go... it's challenge time!

LUNA

Last week, we heard your success stories. This week, we want you to DO something!

TEKİR

Here's your challenge: Make ONE phone call in English this week!

LUNA

It can be anything:

- Calling a restaurant to ask about their hours
- Calling a hotel to ask about prices
- Calling customer service with a question
- Even calling a friend who speaks English!

TEKİR

It doesn't have to be long. Even 2 minutes counts!

LUNA

And here's what we want to know: What did you call about? How did it go? How did you feel AFTER the call?

TEKİR

Drop your story in the comments on YouTube! Best 5 stories will be featured in next week's episode!

LUNA

And remember: it's okay to be nervous. We ALL get nervous! The point is to TRY!

TEKİR

You've got this!

SEGMENT 8: OUTRO (10:45-11:15)

LUNA

Well everyone, that's Episode 002!

TEKİR

Thank you SO much for hanging out with us today!

LUNA

If you enjoyed this episode, please hit that subscribe button! And turn on notifications so you never miss an episode!

TEKİR

Leave a comment with your phone call challenge story! We can't wait to hear how it goes!

LUNA

And if you learned something today, share this episode with a friend who's also learning English!

TEKİR

Remember...

LUNA

Listen.

TEKİR

Laugh.

BOTH

Learn!

LUNA

I'm Luna...

TEKİR

And I'm Tekir...

BOTH

And we'll see you next time on PodCat English!

TEKİR

Now go make that phone call! You've got this!

LUNA

Bye everyone!

Key Takeaways From This Episode

Opening a Call:

- "Hello, this is [name] calling about..."
- "Hi, I'd like to speak to [person], please"
- "Good morning, I'm calling to ask about..."

When You Don't Understand:

- "I'm sorry, I didn't catch that. Could you repeat it?"
- "Could you speak a bit slower, please?"
- "Could you spell that for me?"

Leaving a Message:

- "Could I leave a message for [person]?"
- "Please let them know that [name] called"
- "Could you ask them to call me back?"

Closing a Call:

- "Thank you for your help!"
- "I appreciate your time"
- "Have a great day!"

Pro Tips:

- Write down key phrases before calling
- Have important info ready (dates, numbers, names)
- It's okay to ask someone to repeat!
- Speak slowly and clearly
- Don't panic if you make mistakes
- Practice makes perfect!

This Week's Challenge

Make ONE phone call in English!

It can be:

Restaurant inquiry, Hotel booking, Customer service question, Calling a friend - Anything!

Tell us: 1) What did you call about? 2) How did it go? 3) How did you feel?

Best 5 stories featured in Episode 003!

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